Marco Bernasocchi.

CEO of OPENGIS.ch · Chair of QGIS.org · OSGeo board member · Creator of QField

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SKILLS

Software
Python, PyQt/Qt and QML, Django, C++, CMake, SQL, JavaScript, bash

Data and infrastructure
PostgreSQL/PostGIS, Docker, CI/CD, Linux, git and distributed development

GIS
QGIS (desktop, server, plugins), mobile GIS, web mapping, spatial databases

Management
Company leadership, product management, open-source governance, community building, stakeholder and project management

EDUCATION

University of Zurich
MSc in Geography, Geographic Information Science, minor in Computer Science · 2008 – 2011
BSc in Geography, minors in Computer Science and Cartography · 2003 – 2007

Uppsala University, Sweden
Bachelor thesis in GIS · 2006

LANGUAGES

Italian (native)
English, German, French, Spanish (fluent)
Romansh (conversational)
Portuguese, Swedish (understanding)

OUTSIDE WORK

Ski instructor trainer, technical diving instructor, paraglider pilot and mountaineer. Two kids, and a long list of mountains still to climb.

Profile

Geographer and software engineer who has worked in open-source GIS since 2007. I created QField, the field app for QGIS, which has passed two million downloads, and I run OPENGIS.ch, a company of around 50 people and the second biggest contributor to QGIS core. Since 2020 I have chaired QGIS.org, and since 2022 I have sat on the board of the Open Source Geospatial Foundation. My work moves between code, product, company and community governance, and I am happiest when those four pull in the same direction.

Experience

OPENGIS.ch, Laax

CEO since Dec 2014 · Founder since Dec 2010

Founded as a sole proprietorship and incorporated as OPENGIS.ch GmbH in December 2014, co-owned with Matthias Kuhn. Grew the company from a one-person business to around 50 people working on QGIS core, QField, QFieldCloud and Georama, with support contracts and custom development for public administrations, NGOs and companies across Europe and beyond.

- Lead strategy, sales and operations; OPENGIS.ch is the second biggest contributor to QGIS core
- Launched a QGIS sustainability initiative in 2019, funded through support contracts
- Launched Georama (georama.io) in 2026 for publishing maps and geospatial stories on the web

QField and QFieldCloud

Creator and product lead · 2011 – present

- Ported QGIS (over a million lines of code) and its 10+ C/C++ dependency libraries to Android on my own, starting as a Google Summer of Code project in 2011; this became QField
- QField has over two million downloads, about 1.7 million installs on Google Play and around half a million monthly active users on Android
- Project manager and co-architect of QFieldCloud, including the backend data model and Docker infrastructure; the cloud service now funds most of QField's development
- QField won Best of Swiss Apps in 2022

GEM Foundation (Global Earthquake Model)

QGIS and Python consultant · Mar 2013 – Oct 2020

Consultant, developer and trainer on the OpenQuake Integrated Risk Modelling Toolkit (PyQt with JavaScript), working on the more complex parts of the user-facing tools and the database models.

The World Bank and AusAID (InaSAFE)

Geospatial consultant, Python developer and open-source advocate · Aug 2012 – Jul 2017

Co-developer of InaSAFE, open software for natural hazard impact scenarios. Led the data aggregation, post-processing and metadata modules. InaSAFE won a Black Duck Open Source Rookies of the Year award.

Google Summer of Code

Mentor, QGIS for mobile devices · 2012 | Student developer, QGIS for Android · 2011

Teaching

- Spatial databases and web mapping, Bildungszentrum Geomatik Schweiz · 2017 – 2022
- Seminars on entrepreneurship and open source, Department of Geography, University of Zurich
- JavaScript, Ajax, databases and Python on the BA/BSc (Hons) Web Development track, SAE Institute Zurich · 2010 – 2015
- PHP and databases, Zürcher Lehrbetriebsverband ICT · 2015

bernawebdesign.ch

Founder and lead developer · 2002 – 2010

Small web studio building database-driven web applications and e-marketing solutions for SMBs.

University of Zurich

IT supporter · Nov 2004 – Feb 2006

Open-source leadership

- **QGIS.org**, Chair since May 2020, Co-chair May 2018 – Apr 2020. Run votes and elections, look after GitHub and the user groups, and led the community mission and vision work (Firenze 2022), the “spatial without compromise” claim (Den Bosch 2023) and the funding for the new qgis.org website and brand (2024)
- **OSGeo**, member of the board of directors since January 2022
- **QGIS User Conference 2026**, organiser, held at 2222 m in Laax with 420 people from more than 30 countries
- Named the QGIS 2.0 release “Dufour” (2013)

Keynotes and talks

- *The importance of seeding: from 3 ECTS to shaping a better world*, opening keynote, FOSS4G 2023, Prizren
- *Who pays your bills? Sustainability, community and business: the open source triangle*, FOSS4G 2025
- *Connecting the dots around QGIS*, FOSS4G 2026
- *Who pays for open source?*, MapScaping Podcast, July 2026
- Regular talks on open-source business, QField and QGIS at user conferences across Europe

Selected publications

- Graser A., Sutton T., Bernasocchi M. (2025). The QGIS project: Spatial without compromise. *Patterns* 6(7), 101265
- Fedosov A., Gürçınar E., Fluri L., Bernasocchi M., Kuhn M., Çöltekin A. (2025). Designing an AR viewer for QField: towards supporting geospatial data handling in situ for emergency response. *Abstracts of the ICA* 9
- Metherall N. et al. incl. Bernasocchi M. (2026). Free and open-source machine learning workflows for co-creating national-scale classification models through country-driven QField surveys and Digital Earth Pacific. *ISPRS Archives*
- Khazai B. et al. incl. Bernasocchi M. (2014). Integrated risk modelling toolkit and database for earthquake risk assessment. *2nd European Conference on Earthquake Engineering and Seismology*
- Bernasocchi M., Çöltekin A., Gruber S. (2012). An open source geovisual analytics toolbox for multivariate spatio-temporal data in environmental change modelling. *ISPRS Annals*
- Bernasocchi M. (2011). Visualising multivariate spatio-temporal data: design and evaluation of an open source software environment based on 3D DEMs and multiple linked views. MSc thesis, University of Zurich

Selected projects

- PostgreSQL/PostGIS data model and deployment for Schweizerische Südostbahn AG
- National fish occurrence databases for the Norwegian Institute for Nature Research, integrating Swedish and Finnish occurrence and gill-net data in PostGIS using Darwin Core
- QGIS Server infrastructure for the Canton of Zug with automatic deployment, health checks, connection pooling and load balancing
- Parts of QGIS Globe and several QGIS plugins, developed during my MSc